

“THE OBJECT OF THIS WORK IS TO EXPLAIN... THE CHANGES OF STRUCTURE ARISING FROM MORBID ACTIONS IN SOME OF THE MOST IMPORTANT PARTS OF THE HUMAN BODY.”

Matthew Baillie, British physician, in Preface to *The Morbid Anatomy of Some of the Most Important Parts of the Human Body*, 1793

IN REVOLUTIONARY

PARIS, the first natural history museum in France, the Muséum national d'Histoire naturelle (National Museum of Natural History), was founded on June 10. It was built in the former Jardin Royal des Plantes Médicinales (Royal Garden of Medicinal Plants), created by King Louis

XIII in 1635. It became the Jardin des Plantes—a botanical garden and home to **one of the world's first public zoos**, founded in 1795.

On July 22, British explorer **Alexander Mackenzie** (1764–1820) became the first known man to **cross the continent of North America** north of Mexico, when his Peace River Expedition finally reached the end of its journey just west of Bella Coola in British Columbia, Canada.

A lead mine near the British village Strontian became the site of the **discovery of a new element, strontium**. In 1790, Irish chemist Adair Crawford (1748–95) and his British colleague, chemist William Cruikshank (d. c.1810) noticed that some local lead ores had an unusual make-up. Various scientists, such as German chemist Martin Klaproth (1743–1817), began investigating

them and in 1793 British chemist **Thomas Charles Hope** (1766–1844) **named them strontites** after the village in the Scottish highlands where the mine was located. In 1808, British chemist Humphry Davy **isolated a new element from these ores**, a soft metal called strontium.

John Dalton (1766–1844), the British scientist who proposed an

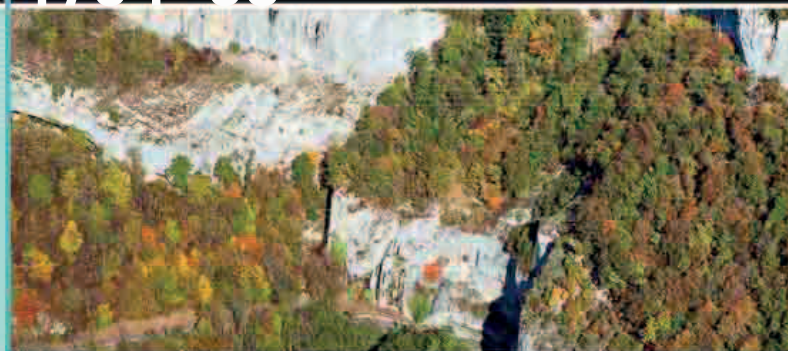
Muséum national d'Histoire naturelle

The world's first great natural history museum opened in Paris just a few months after Louis XVI of France was guillotined nearby.

atomic theory in 1803, published *Meteorological Observations and Essays* in 1793. In it, Dalton wrote on everything from barometers to cloud formation, explaining how moisture in the air turns to rain when air cools.

British physician Matthew Baillie (1761–1823) published *The Morbid Anatomy of Some of the Most Important Parts of the Human Body*. This was the **first modern scientific study of disease**, and showed how diseases could be better understood by studying their effect on organs after death.

400 YARDS
THE DISTANCE COVERED BY **AGUILERA'S GLIDER**



The limestone rocks of the Jura Mountains on the French–Swiss border formed the basis of the identification of the Jurassic Age.

199 MILLION YEARS
THE AGE OF THE **JURA MOUNTAINS**

IN 1794, AMERICAN INVENTOR ELI WHITNEY (1765–1825)

devised a machine for separating the seeds from cotton to obtain clean fibers for spinning into cloth. His gin, and others like it, was soon in use throughout the American South, leading to a **huge increase in the production of raw cotton** after 1800.

The increase in cotton production was a massive boost to the growing factory towns of northwest England, including Manchester, where in 1794 **John Dalton** presented his **pioneering studies on color blindness**. Dalton was blind to green, and he believed it was blue fluid in his



British chemist Thomas Charles Hope names “strontites”

May 15 Spanish inventor Diego Marín Aguilera flies a glider about 1,180 ft (360 m)

July 22 British explorer Alexander Mackenzie reaches the Pacific Ocean

British scientist John Dalton writes about meteorology

British physician Matthew Baillie writes about pathology

June 10 The Muséum national d'Histoire naturelle is founded in Paris

1794 The Jardin des Plantes in Paris becomes home to one of the first public zoos

1794 American inventor Eli Whitney devises cotton gin

1794 British scientist John Dalton writes about color blindness

1794 German physicist Ernst Chladni suggests meteorites come from space